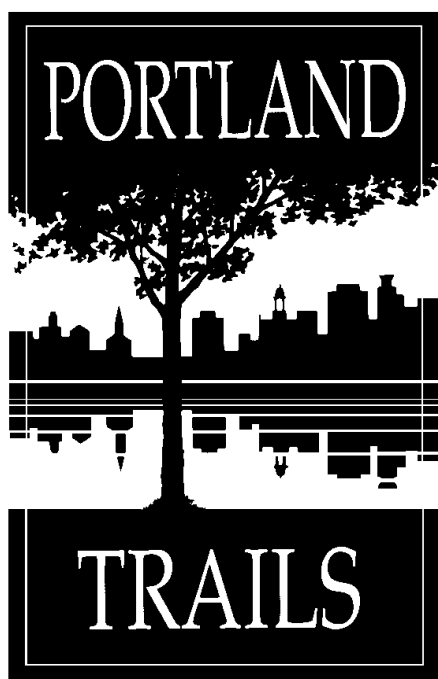




FALL NEWSLETTER 2002

Volume 11 Number 3

OUR GOALS

To create a 30-mile network of multi-use trails within Greater Portland.

To serve as a public advocate for the protection of and access to natural places within the region.

To encourage the participation of neighborhoods, schools and the business community in trail use and stewardship.

Community & Kids Build Trails – Trails Build Community and Kids

BY LAURA NEWMAN

M

AY WAS A TREMENDOUS MONTH for school/community trails! Actually, it was the culmination of over two years' efforts on trail projects at Hall, Lyseth and Moore Schools. Portland Trails works with schools to involve students in designing and building trails that are part of their schoolgrounds and neighborhoods.

It is our goal that through these experiences, students will not only gain a connection to natural areas, but also learn that they can play an active role in their community.

We hope that teachers will make use of the trails and the green spaces around their schools as resources for teaching. Also, these trails serve as routes for students to walk or bike to school, for walkers and runners, and to help build community interaction as neighbors, friends and families cross paths (literally). Take a walk and see what has been accomplished! (Directions to the trails are below).

THE HALL SCHOOL TRAIL

When we first met two years ago with Hall teachers MaryAnn Healey, Kristin Uhlig, and Rita Rubin-Long, they were already taking students to the beautiful wooded ravine behind the school, but were interested in involving kids in a



Students designed posters like this one, by 4th grader Collin Manglass and 3rd grader Will Dykes, to raise awareness about the new trail.



Laura Newman photo

Hall parent Jim Kessler and his son Austin take a well-deserved break trailside on the granite bench placed by last year's fifth grade as a class gift.

more permanent trail effort that would benefit the school and community. They found grant money, worked with students on developing trail design ideas and creating posters to raise awareness, and communicated with parents and other teachers about the project. Portland Trails was able to get additional grants for materials, bring in landscape professionals to help design the trail, and organize and publicize the trail workdays. After many site walks, meetings, emails and phone calls, the work began!

An enthusiastic community group showed up for the first workday morning to help us get a great start. Brush was

[continued on next page]

Community & Kids

[continued from front page]

cleared, surfaces leveled out, two small footbridges were built, and during the following week over 300 students, teachers, and parents came out to load wheelbarrows and spread trail material on the scenic path, which runs along Capisic Brook.

Between wheelbarrow loads, students observed the large holes pileated woodpeckers had made in a tree nearby. Many were able to hear the distinctive calls and spot the large birds traversing the area. The brook greenway is home to many species of birds and animals. As the water becomes cleaner over the next 8 years, it will be safer for humans, too; there is currently e-coli present, but this will be eliminated by the City project to separate sewer and stormwater overflow drains, which are currently combined. The finished trail will include a 40' boardwalk and an outdoor classroom/deck which will be built with student and community input in September.

LYSETH-MOORE-PINE GROVE PARK TRAIL

"I didn't even know there was a park there!" is what so many neighbors and teachers at the nearby schools have said about beautiful Pine Grove Park, where cathedral-height pines create a quiet retreat on a hill above the surrounding neighborhood. Families and walkers and runners of all ages have begun to explore the trail that now connects the park to Lyseth Elementary and Moore Middle schoolgrounds.

So many hands have contributed to this trail over the last two years! Over 400 students, neighbors, parents, teachers and PT members turned out to help during the week of May 11th. They cleared brush, laid trail material, set culverts and built a bridge near the entrance to the park. Neighbors generously offered use of their tools, storage space and water.

Last Fall, Victor Serio's 6th grade advisory group had given



Above: Teachers Susan Healey, Rita Rubin-Long and parent Penny Sarvis with Hall School trailbuilders.

Middle: Trailbuilding buddies at Hall.

Below: PT Executive Director Nan Cumming came out to supervise the dumping and raking of "superhumus" trail material by Hall School students.



input on the design of the section of trail leading to the park, and in May built the framework for the bridge (as a cold rain fell!) Also, thanks to the work of students and parents from Lyseth's Nature Club and the Department of Public Works, a trail crosswalk and signs were installed on Allen Avenue in

June. This July we had terrific help on the trail from kids in Gorham's Summer Rec. Program. (see Mile 0.0). The first section of this trail was built in May 2000 by students and community from Lyseth; ultimately it will branch out from the park and schoolgrounds to connect with other trails and greenspaces.

OTHER SCHOOL PROJECTS...

At Lincoln Middle School students have been working for two years on *Dreamscapes*, a project to redesign their schoolyard. Portland Trails has begun working with them on the design process and hopes to help them realize

some of their goals in the next few years.

First graders in Andrea Napolitano's class at Riverton School built a small trail leading to a wetland and pond behind their school this spring. Portland Trails met with the class and Riverton teachers over the past year and we hope to work with them on expanding the scope of this project during the coming year. If you are interested in our school projects, please contact Education & Community Outreach Coordinator Laura Newman at the PT office or laura@trails.org. 🐾



Lyseth school trailbuilders and teacher
_____ **get a visit from**
Principal Jeff Porter

THANK YOU TO THE many teachers, administrators and staff people at Hall, Lyseth and Moore schools who contributed time and support. Special thanks to Jaime Parker for his construction expertise, Tom Farmer, Amy Segal and David Buchanan for their skillful trail design work, to Trail Steward Bud Quinn for his ongoing help (and entertaining stories), and NYA senior Peter Mascetta for his wonderful work with kids. We thank the City of Portland, Portland Parks and Recreation Department and the Portland Water District for permission to build.

These projects were made possible by the Horizon Foundation's support of our education program, and the Simmons Foundation and the Margaret Burnham Charitable Trust who both funded trailbuilding supplies.

HOW TO GET TO THE SCHOOL TRAILS:

The Lyseth-Moore-Pine Grove Park Trail can be accessed from the schoolgrounds, which are on Auburn St. just past Northgate Plaza, or from Allen Ave. next to the Unitarian Church, or from the trail right-of-way into the Park from Virginia Street, off of Allen Ave.

The Hall School Trail will extend from the entrance road off of Warwick Street (a right turn off of outbound Brighton Ave. after Breakwater School, but before Marden's) to Pinecrest Street.

Schedule of Events

Sunday, September 22nd, 8:30 a.m.

Portland Trails 10K Race/Walk

■ Back Cove and Eastern Prom Trails

Join in the fun at the third annual Portland Trails 10K race/walk. The course follows the scenic Eastern Prom Trail under Tukey's Bridge, around Back Cove and back to the finish near India Street. Gift certificates will be awarded to the top three male and female finishers. Walkers are encouraged to participate in our non-competitive 10K walk. Come be a part of this successful fundraiser that celebrates healthy recreation out on the trails! Call the office at 775-2411 for a registration form.

Wednesday, September 25th, 6:30 - 8:00 p.m.

Portland Trails Annual Meeting and Board of Trustees Meeting

■ Casco Bay Ferry Terminal Conference Room

Portland Trails will hold the business portion of our annual meeting at the beginning of our regularly scheduled September board meeting. Trustee elections and committee reports will be given. Fiscal Year-End reports will be given at a celebratory public Annual Meeting in January. Members are welcome to attend both events.

Friday, October 25th, 5:30 - 9:00 p.m.

Portland Trails Splash: Silent Auction Gala to Preserve the Presumpscot

■ The Pavilion, 188 Middle Street, Portland

Place your bids and help support our campaign, "Preserving the Presumpscot from Forest to Falls" at this year's silent auction. Join host Amy Sinclair for a fun evening of bidding and live music at the Pavilion. With great silent auction items like an a kayak



from L.L. Bean, getaways to the White Mountains, Chebeague Island, Diamond Island, and Islesboro, as well as fine arts and crafts, restaurant gift certificates and more, this will be a great opportunity for you to do some early holiday shopping while supporting a great cause. Look for your invitation in the mail—everyone who purchases a ticket before October 1st will receive a free raffle ticket!

NEWS FROM MILE 0.0

◆ Last year, Portland Trails and the City of Portland partnered on a successful proposal to the **Maine Department of Transportation** for federal Transportation Enhancement Funds. Our proposal addressed the need to create a multi-use trail around the new I-295 interchange near Portland's Sewall Street. This trail is especially important because it will allow safe bicycle and pedestrian access to and from the new bus and train station. Eventually this path will also connect the Fore River and Stroudwater Trails to the downtown area—a crucial connection in the Portland Trails network. MDOT should begin construction this fall.

◆ Thank you to all the kids from **Gorham Recreation Department's** summer program (and their counselors) who did such tremendous trailbuilding work (during four very hot, humid July Mondays!) on the Lyseth/Moore/Pine Grove Trail and the Stroudwater Trail. The program includes one day of community service each week; we were fortunate to have their help!

◆ The **Gannett Foundation** and **WCSH** made a \$2,000 grant to Portland Trails earlier this year. The funds have supported our stewardship efforts all summer—buying the materials and equipment we need for building, maintaining and repairing trails all over town.

◆ The **Rotary Club of Portland Maine** is supporting the design and construction of a new trailhead sign for the Eastern Prom Trail. Designed by Tony Taylor, the kiosk-style sign will offer directions and distances, and feature a map of the trail. The Portland Rotary Service and Memorial Fund and Members of Portland Rotary are donating the sign in memory of Robert G. Booth, Rotarian of the Year for 1997.

◆ Crews from **L.L. Bean** have been working with Portland Trails all summer, doing trail building and maintenance projects on the Oat Nuts and Hall School trails. L.L. Bean encourages their staff to do team building volunteer projects—Portland Trails is fortunate to be the recipient of such great energy from a wonderful group of trail enthusiasts!

◆ Maine's first **Maine Trails Conference/Workshop**, "Finding Common Ground," is scheduled for October 18 and

19 at the Grand Summit Conference

Center in Sunday River, Maine.

The keynote speaker will be Stuart Macdonald, Recreational Trails Program Manager for the Colorado State Parks. Workshops will address topics such as landowner issues and trail management issues. Session highlights include: ADA/Trails for Everyone, Trails & the Law, Trail Construction/Renovation, Mapping & GPS, the Design of Bridges & Structures, and the Economic Benefits of Trails. The conference is sponsored by the Maine Trails Advisory Committee and the Bureau of Parks and Lands, Maine Department of Conservation. Call the Bureau of Parks and Lands at 287-3821 for a brochure and registration form or visit their web site: www.state.me.us/doc/parks.



Gorham Rec. trailbuilders making a valiant effort in the July heat on the Stroudwater Trail.

Laura Newman photo

◆ Education & Community Outreach Coordinator Laura Newman has just returned from a *School Gardening Conference* in Evanston, Illinois. Last fall, she attended a *School Grounds Transformation* workshop in Halifax. Laura plans to put her new knowledge to work as she embarks upon Portland Trails' schoolyard greening initiative. The Aristotle Fund of the Maine Community Foundation has just awarded Portland Trails a \$10,000 grant in support of the new schoolyard project.

Trails as Classrooms

PORTLAND TRAILS' MISSION IS NOT only to create trails and preserve open space but to encourage the participation of neighborhoods, schools, and the business community in trail use and stewardship. Accordingly, six years ago, Portland Trails instituted an Education Program as part of our community outreach effort. For the past four years, Laura Newman has headed up this important effort.

During this period, Portland Trails' education program has been tremendously successful. Over 70 teachers have participated in our three summer workshops, and the curriculum guide produced in 1999 has been widely distributed and is now being expanded.

As chronicled in our feature article, these efforts have resulted in the development of two new trails: one at Lyseth Elementary School and Moore Middle School in North Deering and the other at the Hall Elementary School which serves the Capisic and Stroudwater neighborhoods. Plans are underway to work with a number of other schools in Portland.

Lyseth and Moore School students began their trail two years ago and are finishing it up this year. Initially, 3rd grade students of Val Healy and Marilyn Philbrook developed a design for what is now the Lyseth Moore-Pine Grove Park Trail. The trail extends from the rear of the Lyseth School property and along the side of the Allen Avenue Unitarian Universalist Church (the church is another partner in the trail) to cross Allen Avenue. From there, the trail has recently been extended through a new neighborhood and all the way to the City's Pine Grove Park.

Collectively Lyseth and Moore students and teachers laid the groundwork for a trail which now serves walkers, runners, and bikers in their own neighborhood — not to mention a trail for students at Lyseth Elementary and Lyman-Moore Middle School to walk to and from school. A casual observer in the neighborhood on any day will see the trail getting regular use by people of all ages.

Following two years of planning with Hall Elementary School teachers MaryAnn Healey, Kristin Uhlig, and Rita Rubin-Long, Portland Trails kicked off a trail project with the Hall last spring. A section of this trail has already been laid out under the leadership of Laura Newman and Hall School Project Manager Clarkson Woodward. In upcoming years, Portland Trails hopes to work with Hall School students and teachers to complete this trail and connect it to trails leading to and from Evergreen Cemetery and the Fore River Trail and Maine Audubon Sanctuary.

For their work in preserving and opening up valuable green spaces for all of us who live in and around Portland to enjoy, Hall School, Lyseth School and Moore School teachers, their students, and numerous teachers and students at other schools deserve our gratitude.



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VOLUNTEER PROFILE

BY CHERI MUSGRAVE

Jaime Parker

PORTLAND TRAILS CONTINUES TO attract great volunteers: Jaime Parker is a recent case in point. Those of us who have enjoyed the new footbridges on the Presumpscot trail and the bridges on the trails around Hall and Lyseth Schools have enjoyed the end products of Jaime's hard work and talent.

A strong believer in alternative transportation, Jaime was a regular Portland Trail user. He and his wife Leah live on Munjoy Hill, and the Eastern Prom Trail is a regular transportation route to and from town. Jaime came to Portland Trails to offer help as a volunteer and attended meetings of several different committees looking for the most suitable way to offer his services. Trail work seemed the best fit as Jaime has his own carpentry business. He also has a strong belief in the value of recycling, which he put to practice in his trail building work, and which leads us to a deeper look at Jaime.

Jaime grew up in Rockport, Massachusetts and went to the University of Massachusetts at Amherst. After college he landed on Martha's Vinyard doing carpentry work. Yearning for country life and a place to call home, he and a group of friends bought land in Albany Township, Maine. In the ultimate act of recycling, they disassembled, moved and reassembled a cabin from Harvard, Massachusetts to the land in Maine. He and Leah now share this solar-powered house with seven other co-owners.

The route from Martha's Vinyard to Albany Township took Jaime and Leah through Portland, and being ready for some urban culture, they decided to make it their home. They love the size of our city and how easily one can escape it to the country.

Jaime's favorite trail is the Presumpscot, where it's easy to feel as though you're in the country while still within city limits. Portland Trails board member Elizabeth Ehrenfeld



Laura Newman photo

related this story of his contribution to the creation of four new footbridges for this trail: not only did Jaime design the bridges, he measured and cut salvaged lumber to size, bundled it together and floated it down the Presumpscot River between two kayaks, Jaime in one and Elizabeth in the other, to the site where he led the work crew building the bridges.

Two other trail efforts have benefited from Jaime's talent.

The Lyseth and Hall School trail projects have been ongoing this year, with trail workdays involving kids from Portland and Gorham. Again, salvaged lumber was donated by Jaime for use in these projects. Laura Newman, Portland Trails Education and Community Outreach Coordinator, says "Jamie is a godsend. He's such an asset because of his construction experience and he's wonderful working with kids. He came just at the right time".

To fully profile Jaime would require more space than we have in our newsletter. He also publishes and writes with others a free "quasi-political/environmental" magazine entitled "Ignatio Ratio" which includes essays, poetry and covers current events. Past issues have tackled topics such as conspicuous consumption and utopian ideals. Two issues have come out so far and it is distributed in coffee shops, used book stores, Videopoint and the free newspaper boxes. Jaime and Leah welcomed their first child, Jonah Cross Parker, on August 4th. In the future I'm sure we will see a child's seat attached to Jaime's bike as he spins around town on the trails he has helped to create. We cannot thank him enough for his efforts. 🐾

THANK YOU!

These are the generous businesses that sponsored Portland Trails' 10K Race/Walk this year.

MAJOR SPONSORS: Cianbro ■ Campaign For A Healthy Portland, Portland Public Health Division

CONTRIBUTORS: Patagonia ■ Norway Savings Bank ■ SMRT ■ Hannaford ■ MaineToday.com ■ WBAE, The Bay AM 1490
The Portland Press Herald ■ Kinko's ■ LT's inc.

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Intermed ■ Orthopaedic Associates of Portland ■ Portland Water District ■ PowerBar
Shipyards Brewing Company ■ Sportshoe Center

Portland Trails Map and Trail Guide is now available!

OUR BEAUTIFUL NEW FOUR-color illustrated map covers Portland and parts of Falmouth, Westbrook, and South Portland and was designed by Map Adventures of Portland, Maine. The map shows more than 25 trails, as well as parks, beaches, nature sanctuaries, and other public open spaces. Portland's new bike lanes are also included. The trail guide offers clear directions to all of the trails with details such as trail distance, trail surface, facilities, parking, dog-walking policies, and points of interest. Hiking and biking safety tips, trail etiquette, public transportation options, and "Leave no Trace"



principles are also described. Portland Trails "Map and Trail Guide" is a free benefit of membership for our members at the \$35 level and above.

The map retails for \$4.95. It is available at www.trails.org or at these Portland stores: The Book Review, Books Etc., Casco Bay Books, CycleMania, Emerson's Books, Foods on the Go, Jetport Gas and Convenience, Maine Audubon Society, Maine MountainWorks, Nonesuch Books

Portland Trails would like to extend a special thank you to the Shipyard Brewing Company for hosting Portland Trails "Map and Trail Guide" publication party on August 5th. It was a fun, festive way to celebrate our accomplishment. Shipyard treated more than 50 Portland Trails members and friends to free pizza and beer at the party. Many folks also enjoyed a tour of the brewery. Shipyard continues to be a great supporter of Portland Trails!

GUEST EDITORIAL by Christine Noble

Walking with a Purpose

IF SOMEONE WERE TO ASK YOU if you would like to contract diabetes, would you say yes? Of course not! Yet many Americans are doing just that. For many, Type II diabetes is directly related to being overweight and sedentary. More children and adolescents than ever before are being diagnosed with Type II diabetes. **Diabetes will kill more people in a year than AIDS and breast cancer combined.** It is the fifth leading cause of death in our country, with 17 million Americans suffering with this deadly disease. There are 16 million Americans with pre-diabetes. But by taking the necessary steps now, such as exercising and altering their diet, many will be able to reduce their risk of contracting diabetes.

Simply walking five times a week for 30 minutes each day can reduce the risk of developing Type II diabetes. And, thanks to organizations such as Portland Trails,

Portland is one of the most walkable cities in the nation. The majority of Portland's residents live within ten minutes of a walking trail. What better way to make the commitment to better health than by walking with a purpose? The "America's Walk for Diabetes" will be held in seven cities here in Maine. The Portland walk will be around Back Cove on Saturday, October 5th. The "America's Walk for Diabetes" is one of many ways that The American Diabetes Association raises the much needed funds for our research, education and advocacy programs. To register, please call 1-800-254-WALK.

The mission of the American Diabetes Association is: *To prevent and cure diabetes and to improve the lives of all people affected by diabetes. For more information on our organization, please call 1800DIABETES or visit our web site at www.diabetes.org.*

Sources: CDC, The American Diabetes Association

EVERY WEEK, 19,000 PEOPLE LEARN THAT THEY HAVE DIABETES. How many of that number will be your friends, loved ones or co-workers? **If you have any of the following symptoms, please contact your health care provider:**

- | | | | |
|---|--|--|--|
| ☐ Frequent urination | ☐ Extreme hunger | ☐ Unusual weight loss | ☐ Frequent infections |
| ☐ Unusual thirst | ☐ Extreme fatigue | ☐ Blurred vision | |
| ☐ Tingling numbness in hands or feet | ☐ Cuts and bruises that do not heal | | |

Presumpscot River Preserve

UPDATE

BY NAN CUMMING



AS YOU KNOW, Portland Trails has a vision to protect land along the Presumpscot River in greater Portland and we are currently working with the **Portland Landbank Commission** to accomplish this goal. You may have heard that the City has already purchased the largest, 48-acre parcel in North Deering. In order to close that deal last spring, the City took out a bond to pay for the property. Portland Trails is raising the funds needed to fulfill our promise to reimburse them for the purchase of that land. So it's crucial that we meet our \$487,000 capital campaign goal before the end of the year. Please help as much as you can!

As Portland Trails continues to raise funds, we are also beginning to extend our network of trails to the new Presumpscot River Preserve. Right now, a group of stakeholders is drafting a management plan for the preserve. The plan will begin by outlining the cultural and natural history of the area and documenting the state of the land today. Portland Trails' vision for a greenway all along the river will also be described as part of the plan. Specific issues like the usage of the preserve, signage that will be needed, stewardship and management responsibilities as well as access, parking, and trail design will all be addressed. The plan will also lay the groundwork for the conservation easement that Portland Trails will hold on the property. The stakeholders group is made up of Falmouth and North Deering residents, two members of the mountain biking community, landscape architect Steve Mohr, wildlife biologist Lois Winter, Burnham Martin of the **National Parks Service Rivers and Trails Program**, staff members of the Portland Parks and Recreation Department and **Falmouth Department of Parks and Community Programs**, as well as representatives of the Portland Landbank Commission and Portland Trails.

In support of the Presumpscot River Preserve project, the **Maine Turnpike Authority** has granted the City of Portland a license to locate a section of trail under the Maine Turnpike bridge on the Exit 9 Turnpike Spur. The trail will help connect the Presumpscot River Preserve with other trails upriver.

Dr. Arthur Spiess, Senior Archaeologist at the **Maine Historic Preservation Commission**, will be leading an archaeological survey of the Presumpscot River Preserve in September. The dig is the result of an agreement with the Land for Maine's Future Program that land purchased through LMF funding should be surveyed by the state. Considering what we know of the history of Native American life on the river, as well as past agricultural and industrial uses of the area, the findings should be fascinating! We will keep you informed of what we learn.

Much of the Presumpscot River Preserve is already public property—and many people have been asking us how to get there. Trails have not yet been built, nor have trailhead signs been installed. But a network of informal footpaths and bike paths that have been used by local residents for years can be accessed by the general public. You are welcome to visit—just tread carefully and please respect private property. Parking areas will be constructed next year, so in the meantime be courteous as you use neighborhood, on-street parking.



DIRECTIONS: Take Allen Avenue to Summit Street in Portland's North Deering neighborhood. Follow Summit until you reach Curtis Road. Turn right on Curtis and take another right onto Overset Drive. Continue on Overset until it dead-ends. You may park your car at the end of the road. The trail is clearly visible—follow it straight down to the river.

CALL FOR VOLUNTEERS! PRESUMPCOT SPLASH ■ OCTOBER 25 at THE PAVILION

We need your help to put on the best fundraiser in Portland Trails history! **On the night of the event we need volunteers to:** help run the silent auction doing things like: setting up tables with auction merchandise and displays, staffing the tables, helping to process payments, and cleaning up after the auction. ■ Our "Splash" committee can always use help in preparing for this event. If you have an interest in soliciting silent auction donation items or in event planning, we'd like to hear from you. Please contact Sarah by email at sarah@trails.org or call volunteer coordinator Elizabeth Nolan at 766-5748. ■ Join us and be a part of a night to remember!

PRESUMPSCOT JOURNEY

BY ELIZABETH EHRENFELD

On Wednesday June 13th Roger Berle, Presumpscot Preserve capital campaign chair, and three Registered Maine Guides, including Portland Trails board member Elizabeth Ehrenfeld, made the journey down the Presumpscot River from Sebago to the sea. The trip was 22 miles and



Roger Berle and Steve Gent paddle up to the last remaining covered bridge in Cumberland County (actually a replica as the original was burned by vandals in the 1970s)



Elizabeth Ehrenfeld and George Libby examine the round foundations of the old Gambo gunpowder mill.

included 10 portages around dams. It was a great trip and a wonderful way to see the river and to explore its history. The lower section of the river, just downstream from the Presumpscot Preserve, will be changing this fall when the dam nearest the ocean, Smelt Hill Dam, is removed.

Smelt Hill Dam

BY CHRISTINA WHITE

Take a totaled, multi-million dollar power generation facility and transform it into an outdoor enthusiasts dream? This is the short story of how a flooded hydro dam will result in the restoration of part of a marine ecosystem, the creation of recreational trails, and the expansion of water-related activities on the Presumpscot River.

IN THE MONTHS FOLLOWING THE OCTOBER, '96 FLOOD at the Smelt Hill Dam, then owner, Central Maine Power (CMP) decided the economics did not support the dam being rebuilt. That decision was the first of many steps towards the dam's planned removal this autumn. For over a decade, a number of community-based groups and state organizations had been working on improvements to the 24-mile-long Presumpscot River, a body of water that was listed in 2000 by American Rivers as one of the most endangered rivers in the United States.

Concurrent with CMP's decision to put the dam up for sale were discussions about water-quality improvements, being conducted by the Maine Dept. of Environmental Protection (DEP). If the DEP could purchase and remove the dam, a number of objectives could be achieved. Ultimately, the DEP, the Dept. of Marine Resources (DMR), the Army Corps of Engineers, and the Coastal Conservation Association (CCA) developed a plan to study and then finance the dam removal, at a "flood sale" price. CCA president Pat Keliher noted, "CMP's willingness to sell the facility at about half of its appraised value was a big factor in CCA being able to raise the \$150,000 needed to meet the local match." The dam removal opens up the 7 lower miles of what early settlers described as a river "a foot deep in fish." Opening the river is considered the critical first step towards the further restoration of the entire river.

The effort to clean the Presumpscot and re-establish original fisheries and other recreational activities is not just "a feel-good thing," according to Dusti Faucher, President of The Friends of the Presumpscot. This effort will have real economic benefits, such as natural resource-based enterprises like kayaking, canoeing, and fishing.

The removal will actually allow fish to reestablish their original breeding grounds. According to Dana Murch of the DEP, the removal of dams... "all share one characteristic, and that is to benefit the restoration of sea-run fish and their habitat." It is estimated that over 700,000 fish from three species—alewives, blue-back herring and American shad, so-called "bottom-of-the-food-chain-fish," will return to the river. In addition, the DMR expects to see cod, smelt and Atlantic salmon, "not only increasing productivity in the river, but in Casco Bay as well. This will result in millions of additional pounds of fish being added to the food chain in the Gulf of Maine." 🐟

ON THE TRAILS with Mike Musca



Nan Cumming photo

FOR OUR FIFTEENTH wedding anniversary, my wife and I decided to take our children for a surprise trail walk. (Of course, we celebrated without kids later on with a weekend trip to Lubec, but that's a different story all together.) The day was drizzly and dreary, the kids (ages 9, 11, 13) were in a quarrelsome mood, and no one felt like leaving the warm comfort of our van. Nevertheless, we persevered — i.e., we kicked the kids out of the van.

From our parking spot at the Stroudwater Crossing, our family walked the short distance down Congress Street to the entrance of the Fore River Sanctuary Trail and descended onto the single path trail that I frequently run at lunchtime. Sooner than later, we were ants marching on the muddy trail, splashing every available puddle with delight. After walking for one mile, we crossed the railroad tracks which led us towards Jewell Falls. At this point, the kids complained anew: "Where are we going and when are we getting there?" About a half-mile later, we could hear the roar of the Falls. The kids' eyes danced with delight as they "discovered" the waterfalls tucked in the middle of an urban setting. I highly recommend this walk — complaining kids or not. ☘

The Campaign for the Corner

PORTLAND TRAILS HAS JOINED THE Stroudwater Village Association's *Campaign for the Corner* in an exciting collaborative effort to preserve part of a beautiful "corner" of open space at 1305 Westbrook Street in Stroudwater.

Residents and passersby have long considered the land to be a part of a public park space, because it appears to be a single knoll overlooking the scenic estuary of the Fore River. This land is also part of a travel corridor for the deer, wild turkeys, foxes and geese that make their home in the Maine Audubon Society's Fore River Sanctuary.

The Stroudwater Village Association is a neighborhood organization dedicated to the stewardship of the natural, social and historic character which makes Stroudwater unique. So, when this important parcel next to the corner lot recently came on the market and plans for a house



View from the lot and park to Fore River Sanctuary.

lot were proposed, neighbors and members of the Stroudwater Village Association sprang into action. In their search to find an alternative to development, the Association contacted Portland Trails.

The parcel connects vital open spaces, parks, and trails in the neighborhood, including the historic Stroudwater Cemetery (1729), the Fore River Sanctuary, the Fore River Trail, and the Stroudwater Trail. Both Portland Trails and the Stroudwater Village Association believe strongly that the land adds enormous sense of place to the Stroudwater neighborhood and that its development would be a loss for all of Portland.

Stroudwater residents are passionate about this space—in a quick survey of the neighbors throughout the Village, 90% of Stroudwater residents were willing to give financial support. If you would like to learn more about this exciting campaign—please contact us!

SENIOR STROLL

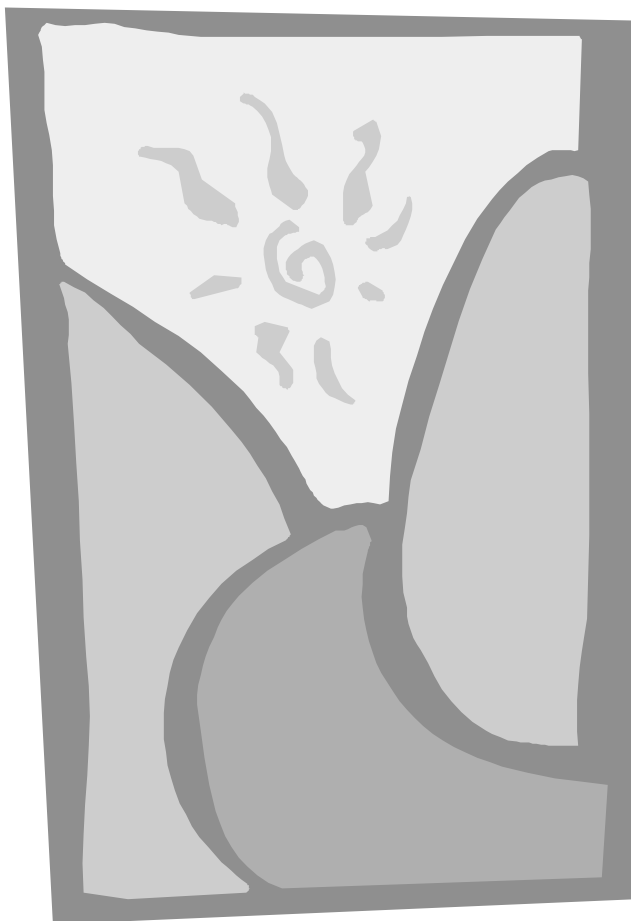
SUMMER DELIVERED ON ITS promise of a spectacular day on Friday, June 21st when Portland Trails launched its program for senior citizens, called Senior Strolls. Hosting this first walk/talk walk was well-known local historian, Herb Adams. Over 53 seniors joined us, with hats, umbrellas, and water bottles, as we strolled the Eastern Prom Trail and listened intently as Herb discussed topics ranging from the role of the Narrow Gauge railroad in the region's industrial development to the War of 1812 and on to the South Portland shipyards and their role in WWII. In the two-hour walk, one senior was overheard saying "we covered 300 years of history in two hours, that's half a century every 20 minutes!"

The Senior Strolls program has three objectives: (1) to familiarize area senior citizens with our beautiful trails, so that trails usage will increase, (2) to strengthen the "senior voice" in our membership, and, (3) long term, to expand our current group of seniors who volunteer with Portland Trails. As we go to press, Mike Auger is scheduled to talk about invasive plants as he leads a walk on the Stroudwater Trail on August 18th. More Senior Strolls will be scheduled soon, call the Portland Trails office for details.

PORTLAND TRAILS

SPLASH!

SILENT AUCTION GALA TO PRESERVE THE PRESUMPSCOT



Silent Auction

from 5:30 – 8 p.m.

Groovy Getaway Raffle

Drawing at 8:30 p.m.

Dance and Bid to Music by:

Darien Brahms

Clown School Dropouts

Elegant Hors d'oeuvres

by Black Tie & **Cash Bar**

Single Admission:

\$15 Portland Trails Members

\$20 Non-Members

Call 775-2411 for tickets –
or buy them at the door!

FRIDAY, OCTOBER 25

The Pavilion & 188 Middle Street, Portland & from 5:30 – 9 p.m.



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Portland, ME 04101
207.775.2411
info@trails.org

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Join Us In Building Portland Trails!

Give this to a friend **or** Suggest someone who might want to join. (We'll send them a free newsletter.)

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Membership Levels:

Bridgebuilder.....\$1000	Family\$50
Trailblazer.....\$500	Individual.....\$35
Pathfinder.....\$250	Student/Senior.....\$10
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